

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Adult & child choking

MEDICAL / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

If someone cannot speak, breathe or cough effectively, call emergency services. For a responsive adult or child, give 5 back blows followed by 5 abdominal thrusts, repeating until the blockage clears or they become unresponsive. Use chest thrusts when pregnant or when you cannot encircle the abdomen.

Do now.

☐**Assess the cough**

01

If the person can cough effectively, encourage coughing and watch closely.

☐**Call for help**

02

Send someone to call emergency services, or use speakerphone without delaying care.

☐**Give back blows and thrusts**

03

Lean them forward for 5 back blows between shoulder blades, then give 5 abdominal thrusts; follow dispatcher guidance.

☐**If unresponsive**

04

Lower them safely and start CPR as directed. Remove only a clearly visible object; never blindly sweep the mouth.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Begin the first-aid sequence immediately while another person calls if possible. If the person becomes unresponsive, lower them safely and begin CPR. Look for a visible object before breaths; never sweep blindly inside the mouth. A delayed ambulance is not a reason to delay first aid.

Watch for.

Do not use abdominal thrusts on an infant under one year; infant care uses back blows and chest thrusts.

People & practical needs.

Give someone the specific task of calling or locating care while another person provides first aid. Keep the patient warm or cool as the condition requires and record what happened and when

Next decision.

Get medical assessment after thrusts or persistent symptoms. Learn separate infant choking care.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Adult & child choking · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/choking/>